continue my career in the flesh – is made more real when a phone call arrives from Andrew Strauss. It's the one that takes place while the girls are with me in the car. It's short and sharp, Strauss informing me that I will not be going on tour to the West Indies. My response is to just get back in the gym, back to work. I have too much more left to give to be shut out now.

When they lose and Joe Root hands over the captaincy to Ben Stokes, my omission is the first thing he brings up in the meeting with new head of cricket, Rob Key. 'I want Jimmy back,' are his first words, to which Key nods and agrees.

At Edgbaston, after I make my return to the side, I take Virat Kohli's wicket again. As I walk off the pitch, he comes up to me and says that he's enjoyed playing against me and it has been a pleasure doing it one final time. 'Why?' I say, 'Are you retiring?'